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» INDIAN FOOTBALL
KALINGA SUPER CUP

IN SEARCH OF THE RIGHT VISION

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Moments after FC Goa went 3-0 up against Jamshedpur FC in the Super Cup 2025 final, a sky-shattering storm consumed the Kalinga Stadium in Bhubaneswar. It felt like the heavens had opened up in celebration — if not for the tournament, then at least for a team that had finally shrugged off its recent stumbles.

“The second goal killed the game, and then the storm almost killed us,” joked head coach Manolo Marquez.

But nothing about FC Goa’s campaign looked vulnerable. It was dominant, deliberate, and ultimately historic. The club became the

The Super Cup remains a tournament **caught between identities**: too short to matter, too tired to inspire.

first to win the Super Cup twice and, more significantly, earned a spot in the AFC Champions League Two (ACL2) 2025–26 season.

For Marquez, who ended his stint at FCG on a high, this was a fitting farewell. But the context around his success couldn’t be ignored. The Super Cup, despite all its intent, still hasn’t figured out what it wants to be.